

Rep. Tom Emmer on What is a Whip?

Facebook

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REP. TOM EMMER:

We're gonna cut all that? Good, thank goodness. Okay. What is a whip? What is a whip? Well, most people don't know. Most people are afraid to ask because they think everybody else knows. People don't really know. They don't understand that the Speaker of the House, that's the number one position. He's in charge of everything. The agenda, the grounds. I mean, he's in charge of Capitol Police offices. The Majority Leader, now this is a job. The Majority Leader is setting the calendar for the year and scheduling the floor, working with committee chairs to determine when legislation is ready to be taken to the floor. I got the best job. The third job in line is the whip's job. We take 218 people now, 219, and get them to work in unison to pass this stuff. Everybody wants to complain about, well, you got the toughest job going because you only have one or two or three extra votes, sometimes no extra votes, and you gotta get everybody on the team to behave like a team. That's why it's the best job in the House. I've said it's the greatest coaching job anyone has ever offered me, and right here is why Herb Brooks is here. He helped them become a team that achieved things that no one ever thought they could achieve in their wildest dreams. It's a lot the same, quite frankly. It's just bigger numbers and people from more diverse places with wildly different views of the world. Your job is not to tell them what to do. Your job is to help them to do what they were hired to do, what the constituents at home sent them here to do. Your job is to help them be the leader that they were elected to be, and it's been incredibly rewarding. It doesn't really matter what I think of the members. I like them all, but whether I agree with them or disagree with them, not important. All that is important is that I respect them. I respect the fact that they're elected by some 700,000 people at home to be their voice here in Washington, D.C. You can accomplish amazing things, and this Congress has done exactly that.

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